Project Guidelines for IBM SkillsBuild University Education

1. What We Are Considering a Project

For our purposes, a **project** is defined as any non-prescriptive solution that aims to address a real-world or business problem using IBM technologies. These technologies may include, but are not limited to:

- **watsonx.ai**
- **watsonx Orchestrate**
- **Langflow**
- **IBM Granite**
- **Docling**

The project must demonstrate how IBM technology is applied to solve the stated problem effectively and provide tangible benefits.

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2. Expected Project Output

Each project should deliver a concise and clear representation of the solution through one of the following formats:

- **Short Video (2–3 minutes)** – posted on YouTube or similar
- **PowerPoint Presentation**

The output must include:

- **Problem Statement**
  - What is the industry problem being addressed?
  - Why is this problem significant?
- **Target User and Pain Points**
  - Who are the target users?
  - What are the user's pain points that you solve?
  - Why don't current solutions solve the problem?
- **Solution Overview**
  - What is the proposed solution?

    - How does the solution solve the problem and deliver value?
- **Architectural Diagram**
    - A visual representation showing how the components interact and work together to solve the problem.
    - How does the solution ensure ethical and responsible use of AI?
- **Demo or Simulation**
    - A short-form demonstration of the solution in action.
    - This does not need to be production-ready but should show functionality or user interaction.

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3. How Projects Will Be Judged

Each submission will be judged based on the following criteria with a **maximum score of 20 points**, and the final score being the average of the evaluators' scores:

- **Completeness and Feasibility (5 points):**
    - How feasible is the solution?
    - How fully has the idea been thought-out and planned?
    - How complete is the proof-of-concept submitted?
    - How clear is the application of IBM technology?
- **Creativity and Innovation (5 points):**
    - How unique and original was the approach in applying AI technology to address the stated issue?
    - Is the solution differentiated in the market?
- **Design and Usability (5 points):**
    - How good is the design, user experience, and ease of use of the solution?
    - How quickly and easily could it be put to use in real-world scenarios and adopted by target users?
- **Effectiveness and Efficiency (5 points):**
    - Does the solution address a high priority and relevant issue within the learning lab theme?
    - Does it achieve its goal effectively and efficiently?
    - Can it achieve a measurable impact in the field?
    - Does it have the potential to scale to more users or use cases?